CORE ITEM UPDATE · INDIA

Core Item Update: Saree blouses and dupattas 2026–28

The blouse and dupatta are the fastest way to refresh an existing look.

Forecut Editorial · 11 October 2026



Overview

The blouse and dupatta are the fastest way to refresh an existing look. Corset blouses rise into the festive season, collared shirt blouses are emerging for office and day wear, and embroidered organza dupattas are at their peak as an add-on.

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INVEST	TEST	MAINTAIN	REDUCE

Invest: rising now. Test: emerging. Maintain: at its peak. Reduce: fading.

The details

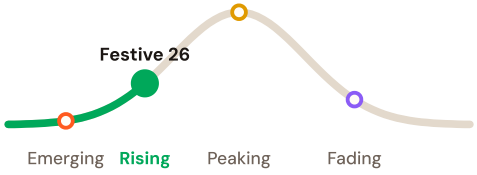
Each detail with its status for Festive 26, its trend curve and what it does next.



INVEST RISING

Corset saree blouses

Structured corset blouses as a modern alternative. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



Festive 26 Rising	Summer 27 Peaking	Festive 27 Peaking
Summer 28 Peaking	Festive 28 Fading	



INVEST RISING

Off-shoulder blouses

Off-shoulder blouses for sarees and lehengas. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



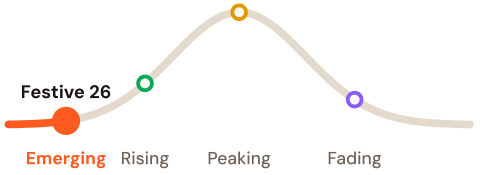
Festive 26 Rising	Summer 27 Peaking	Festive 27 Fading
Summer 28 Fading	Festive 28 –	



TEST EMERGING

Collared shirt blouses

Crisp collared blouses for a tailored saree look. Early signal. Trial in small drops and premium lines.



Festive 26 Emerging	Summer 27 Rising	Festive 27 Rising
Summer 28 Peaking	Festive 28 Peaking	



MAINTAIN PEAKING

Organza dupattas with embroidered borders

Sheer dupattas framed with an embroidered edge. At its height. Keep in core ranges without over-buying.



Festive 26 Peaking	Summer 27 Peaking	Festive 27 Fading
Summer 28	Festive 28	

Fading	–

How to update your saree blouses and dupattas range

- Sell corset and off-shoulder blouses as separates to update existing sarees.
- Test collared shirt blouses with cotton and handloom sarees.
- Use embroidered organza dupattas as an add-on to plain sets.

What to check in saree blouses and dupattas development

- **Blouse fit:** offer padded and non-padded options and clear bust and shoulder measurements.
- **Closures:** back hooks, side zips or front openings for different needs.
- **Dupatta size:** typically around 2.25 to 2.5 metres; state width and edge finish.
- **Mix and match:** design blouses to work with several sarees.

Fabric guide

Choose fabric by occasion, climate and price point. The same design often needs two fabric options: a premium version and a value or summer version.

- Raw silk and brocade for festive blouses
- Organza and net for sheer dupattas
- Cotton and chanderi for everyday
- Velvet for winter weddings

The global view

Indian saree blouses and dupattas sell well beyond India, to South Asian communities in the UK, North America, the Gulf, Southeast Asia and Australia, and increasingly to customers discovering Indian craft. For international customers, provide clear size conversions, care guidance and styling ideas for local events.

Common questions

Are readymade blouses replacing tailored blouses? Readymade blouses in good fits are growing fast, especially online, while tailoring remains important for bridal.

What dupatta trends are rising? Light organza, borders with hand work and dupattas styled as capes or drapes.

See every saree blouses and dupattas detail with design notes and downloadable cards in the India Forecast 2026–28.

Statuses are Forecut's forecast for India: Festive 26 (Oct 2026 – Feb 2027), Summer 27 (Mar – Jul 2027), Festive 27 (Aug – Dec 2027), and long-range outlooks for Summer 28 (Mar – Jul 2028) and Festive 28 (Aug – Dec 2028). Sources: India trends summarise public coverage of Lakmé Fashion Week x FDCI 2026 (Harper's Bazaar India, Free Press Journal), Aza Fashions festive and ethnic trend guides, Lashkaraa colour and silhouette trends 2026, Pearl Academy Gen Z trend reports, Gully Labs, Global Indian (Prada SS26 Kolhapuri-inspired sandals) and Outlook Business (Gen Z and e-retail).